

Alyssa Barrack
University of Central Florida
College of Arts and Humanities
Texts and Technology PhD
alyssa.barrack@ucf.edu
[Google Scholar](#)

Education

University of Central Florida - PhD, 2024-current

- Advisor: Julia Listengarten
- Program: Texts and Technology
- Graduate Research Associate, Teaching Associate, and Teaching Assistant
- Knights Research Scholar Program Team Leader Spring and Fall 2026

University of Central Florida - MA, 2020-2022

- Advisor: Elizabeth Kritzer
- Program: Interdisciplinary Studies

University of South Florida - BA, 2015-2019

- Major: Theatre Arts
- Major: English: Professional Writing, Rhetoric, and Technology
- Dual Degree, 3.96 GPA | Honors College and Departmental Honors Theatre | Awards and Scholarships | Study Abroad | Leadership in Student Theatre Production Board

Academic Positions

- <https://www.ucf.edu/news/ucf-selected-for-national-endowment-for-the-humanities-project-on-ai-in-education/> NEH Grant Fellow
- Artistic Committee Member (Exhibition & Performance Review), ELO [Electronic Literature Organization] 2026 Conference, July 2026. Digital conference.
- Secretary of TTSO [Texts & Technology Student Organization], 2025-2027. Re-founding member, helped to develop constitution, institute as an official student organization with the SGA at UCF, and plan first year+ of board meetings, member meetings, and special event offerings.
- Graduate Research Associate, University of Central Florida, Theatre UCF May 2025 - current.
 - Dramaturgy Coordinator, *Fall/Spring 25/26 and Fall/Spring 26/27 Main Season*
 - Dramaturgy Coordinator, *Pegasus PlayLab 2025 and 2026*

- Research Associate, Theatre UCF Artistic Associate (support for Artistic Director), 25-27
- Teaching Associate, THE 4481 Dramaturgy and TPA 3523 New Play Festival Spring 2026 - Instructor of Record.
- Teaching Associate, TPA 3513 Season Selection and TPA 3523 New Play Festival Fall 2026 - Instructor of Record
- Teaching Associate, TPA 3523 New Play Festival Spring 2027 - Instructor of Record
- Graduate Research Associate, University of Central Florida, Center for Humanities and Digital Research, Aug 2024 - May 2025.
 - Digital Production Assistant, The Marjorie Kinnan Rawlings Journal of Florida Literature, 2025.
- Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Central Florida, Nicholson School of Communication and Media, Aug 2024 - May 2025.
- Adjunct Professor - Stagecraft, Daytona State College, Theatre Department, Spring 2024 and 2026 and Fall 2026.
- Adjunct Professor - Theatre Appreciation, Daytona State College, Theatre Department, Spring and Fall 2026.
- Event Manager, Daytona State College, News Journal Center for Performing Arts, July 2023 - Sept 2024.
 - Contract Event Manager, As Needed, Oct 2024 - Current.
- Theatrical Designer and Artist - Contract, Eastern Florida State College, Theatre Department, Aug 2023 - current.
 - Lighting Design and Programming
 - Scenic Artistry and Painting
- Theatre Technician, Eastern Florida State College, Theatre Department, Aug 2019 - July 2023.
- Theatre Technician, University of South Florida, Events and Production Services, Aug 2016 - May 2018.

Publications

Published Work

- Barrack, Alyssa. "The Drolls: A Dramaturgical Mini-Zine Program". In *Academizines: A Special Issue of Unbound: A Journal of Digital Scholarship*. Eds. Dr. Spencer Keralis and Professor Zach Frazier. (2026).
- Listengarten, Julia, Chloe Edmonson, and Alyssa Barrack. "Devising With the Machine: Artificial Intelligence and Human Creativity in Performance". In *Sentient Books: AI's Impact on Creation*, edited collection by Sandra Sousa and Susana Antunes. (2025).
- MA Thesis: Barrack, Alyssa. *Hitting a Little Too Close to Home: Reflexivity, Liminality, and Identification in Horror across Film, Theatre, and Games*. UCF Stars Repository. (2022).

Book Reviews

- *Decentered Playwriting: Alternative Techniques for the Stage*. Eds. Carolyn M Dunn, Eric Micha Holmes, Les Hunter. Routledge, New York, NY. (2024). Reviewed for LMDA Review.
- Morris, Blake. *Antonin Artaud*. Routledge, New York, NY. (2022). Reviewed for Ecumenica.

Creative Publications

- Barrack, Alyssa. "Intricate Bloody Parodies: Vampiric Allusions in *What We Do in the Shadows*". Horror Scholar Journal (independent), Vol 3. (2020).
- Barrack, Alyssa, "Recognizing Queerness and Self in The Craft: Legacy". Gayly Dreadful. (2021).

Selected Works in Progress

- *In Progress* Barrack, Alyssa. "Adapting Controversy: Audience Discourse in American Psycho Adaptations".
- *In Progress* Barrack, Alyssa. "Identifying Shared Characteristics of Cozy Horror Media".

Conference Presentations

- Working Group, "Dramaturgy Across Space & Civic Dramaturgy", LMDA 40th Annual Retreat, David Geffen Yale School of Drama, New Haven, CT, June 12-14, 2026.
- "The Drolls: A Dramaturgical Mini-Zine – Zines for Audience-Centered Dramaturgy Practice", Academizines! Launch Event and Virtual Zine Con, Virtual, May 2, 2026.
- "Experimental Interactive Dramaturgy: Digital Methods for Production Dramaturgy on *The River Bride*", UCF Libraries AI Day 2026, UCF, April 2026.

- “Experimental Interactive Dramaturgy: Digital Methods for Production Dramaturgy on *The River Bride*”, UCF Creative Scholarship Showcase and UCF Student Scholarship Symposium, UCF, March 2026.
- “AI Discourse through Horror Genre Trope Identification,” Console-ing Passions, Atlanta, Georgia, June 27, 2025.
- “Nordic Death is Not Dichotomous: Depictions of Nordic Afterlife in Jotun (2015) and Hellblade (2017),” SWPACA, Virtual, February, 22, 2021.

Local Talks

- “New Play Dramaturgy Bootcamp”, with Dr. Tracey Brent-Chessum. University of Central Florida, April 2026.
- “Production Dramaturgy Bootcamp”, with Dr. Tracey Brent-Chessum. University of Central Florida, April 22 and 23, 2026.
- “Cult Adaptation and American Psycho”. DCRG Presents, University of Central Florida, December 2, 2024.

Professional Service

- **Volunteer, Exhibitions and Performances Org Team and Moderator/Performances MC** for ELO Conference, 2026.
- **Conference Reviewer** for ELO Conference, 2026.
- **Conference Reviewer** for ACH Conference, 2025 and 2026.
- **Conference Reviewer** for Meaningful play 2026.
- **Peer Reviewer** for UCF Pegasus Review, 2025
- **Volunteer** for Florida Digital Humanities Consortium Conference, UCF, 2024

Production Credits

- **UCF Theatre, 2026-7**, Lead Dramaturg for *Twelfth Night*
- **UCF Pegasus PlayLab**, 2026, Dramaturgy Coordinator and Lead Dramaturg on *Raccoon Play* (new play work).
- **UCF Celebrates the Arts**, 2026. An AI Adventure; devised production with a team of ~10 faculty, graduate, and undergraduate students; led a team of 10 student dramaturgs in developing dramaturgy documentation and lobby materials to support devising process and audience reception.
- **UCF Theatre**, 2025, Dramaturg for *The River Bride*.
- **UCF Pegasus PlayLab**, 2025, Dramaturgy Coordinator and Dramaturg on *The Dolls* (new play work).

- **UCF Celebrates the Arts**, 2025, Late Night with Artificial Intelligence; devised production with a team of ~10 faculty, graduate, and undergraduate students in the Theatre department, acted in the project.

Memberships and Affiliations

- Literary Managers and Dramaturgs of the Americas
- Association for Computing Machinery Special Interest Group on Computer-Human Interaction
- Electronic Literature Organization

Awards and Scholarships

- UCF 2026-27 College of Arts and Humanities (CAH) General Scholarship.
- UCF Graduate Presentation Fellowship - Summer 2026
- UCF Graduate Presentation Fellowship - Summer 2025
- Debbie K. Phillis Space Coast UCF Alumni Chapter Endowed Scholarship - 2025-2026

Skills and Competencies

Digital and Programming Tools:

Proficient

- Claude Code, HTML, Markdown, p5.js, Tracery, GitHub, JSON, CSV

Working Knowledge

- Python, JavaScript, TensorFlow, ChatGPT API

Platforms

- Wix, WordPress, Instructure Canvas

Media and Design Platforms

- Canva
- Adobe InDesign (basic)
- Adobe Premiere (basic)
- Archivist Film Scanner (8mm, Super 8mm, 16mm)

Theatrical and Production Skills

- Scenic Carpentry and Painting
- Stage Lighting (incl. ETC Family Console Programming)
- Technical Direction and Event Production (FOH and BOH)
- QLab
- Event Coordination and Project Management
- Transcription and Data Entry
- Professional Writing and Editing
- House Management